



Didi interact?

DiDi, the interactive teddy bear was backed by 500 start-ups and is powered by an iPad. Read more: <http://dgit.in/itedbr>



Making history

Aereo's case with the American Supreme Court will in one way or the other make history. Find out more about it: <http://dgit.in/aereohist>

academic and non-academic fields and encourage people you know (in real life even) to endorse them.

There's a great search tool for Twitter called Followerwonk many users employ to exclusively search bios in detail. And with even Google scanning through these profiles with emphasis on hashtags, feel free to add hashtags to your profile bio, where appropriate. Of course, it also helps to be funny but that's not a deal breaker.

Don't forget the power of a good profile picture in attracting followers. People like to know who they're following even if they don't recognise them. A clean and decent image is your best bet. If you want to keep your face private, then opt for iconic images like logos or symbols that best represent you.

Go get your followers

Once you've done all this, you'll probably wonder when you'll attract your first follower. Well, you don't have to wait for them to come to you. You can go to them. Start advertising yourself on other social media platforms immediately. Invite the old crowd to the new platform and encourage them to follow you. Sending out polite, well worded email to family and friends can even get you some pity followers. A good start.

The next step is to subliminally influence unsuspecting strangers. Start by including your new social media tag in everything, from email to business cards. Let your social media location find its way unobtrusively onto the internet in comment streams on blogs and YouTube. Make it your own personal sign off. Not

only does this technique work in a subtle way (saving you from looking pushy), but it can also lead to surprising followers down the road since the internet never really erases anything. Even lame YouTube comments. Be sure to mention your social media credentials on your LinkedIn or Glassdoor profile as well. It never hurts to have a CEO among your followers.

You can also start creating a few attractive images that carry a funny quote along with your social media watermark using freely available templates. Upload them on image-sharing websites like Imgur or Instagram for further exposure.

The Bait and Switch

You can begin your journey to stardom by following a few key people who are very active online – usually not mainstream celebrities but social media “influencers” – and easily discoverable through Google searches. Look for people who are even vaguely related to your interests and have a large number of followers. So if you're interested in movies, avoid following politicians (unless it's Arnold Schwarzenegger). This way you'll have greater access to people who're more likely to find you relevant and worth following back. Of course, they're just as likely to unfollow you later, but it gives you enough time to be visible to their followers. Followerwonk is again useful here.

As a rule of thumb, if someone follows you, follow them right back. Even on forums such as Quora, this reciprocity is a necessary courtesy otherwise you risk being unfollowed. If you want to improve your Edgerank or Klout scores as a part of your social media dominance, then tweaking your “followers to following” ratio is also important. Be careful of how quickly you unfollow users who follow you. Platforms like Twitter have systems to detect this kind of behaviour, and you risk being barred from the service. Take at least five days before unfollowing someone.

Another important aspect of Twitter is its 2,000 followers limit. You can only follow up to 2,000 people (unlimited

people can follow you, so no worries) after which you need to fulfil an unknown ratio of “followers to following” to move up. So once you reach this limit, if you want to follow someone new, you'll have to



unfollow someone first. A delicate choice, so try to first pick people who're less likely to realise you've unfollowed them (read: family and friends).

Social scavenging

Another helpful trick to find more followers is by scavenging the list of members who already follow you. Keep an eye out for people who are more into retweeting on Twitter, UpVoting answers on Quora or distributing likes on Facebook. Such people are more likely to follow someone if they're followed first. Shoot off a complimentary message and follow them and if they think you're sufficiently impressive, they'll follow you back.

Also be on the lookout for “whales” i.e. people who follow thousands of accounts. These are a goldmine if you want to get an instant follow back. Quora is one website where these whales can be found with ease. Don't follow them. Instead follow the accounts that follow these whales back. Here's an account as an example: <http://www.quora.com/Martin-Stojcevski-8>. As we

